National
Qualifications
2026

# 2026 Cantonese

# Listening

# Higher

# Question Paper Finalised Marking Instructions

These marking instructions have been prepared by examination teams for use by Qualifications Scotland appointed markers when marking external course assessments.

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**General marking principles for Cantonese Listening Higher**

*Always apply these general principles. Use them in conjunction with the detailed marking instructions, which identify the key features required in candidates' responses.*

**(a)** Always use positive marking. This means candidates accumulate marks for the demonstration of relevant skills, knowledge and understanding; marks are not deducted for errors or omissions.

**(b)** If a candidate response does not seem to be covered by either the principles or detailed marking instructions, and you are uncertain how to assess it, you must seek guidance from your team leader.

**(c)** Award a mark to each answer. Marks are not transferable between questions and the answers for each question must come from the item.

**(d)** Award marks according to the accuracy and relevance of the candidate's answers. Award marks to candidates where the answer is accurate but expressed in their own words.



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**Marking instructions for each question**

**Item 1**

| Question | | | Expected response(s) | Max mark | Additional guidance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | **Do not accept:** |
| **1.** | (a) | | • fewer subjects<br>• more difficult<br><br>**Any 1 from 2** | **1** | |
| | (b) | | • they need to organise their time<br>• they need to spend a lot of time studying by themselves<br><br>**Any 1 from 2** | **1** | |
| | (c) | (i) | • can rest<br>• play games<br>• watch movies<br><br>**Any 2 from 3** | **2** | |
| | | (ii) | • go out and explore<br>• get to know the **city** (you live in) | **2** | |
| | (d) | | • do exercise **every day**<br>• go to bed/ sleep earlier<br>• get up earlier<br><br>**Any 1 from 3** | **1** | |
| | (e) | | • develop interests/hobbies<br>• learn (new) skills<br>• make **more** friends<br><br>**Any 1 from 3** | **1** | |



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**Item 2**

| Question | | | Expected response(s) | Max mark | Additional guidance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | **Do not accept:** |
| **2.** | (a) | | • can learn new things<br>• meet people from different **countries** | **2** | |
| | (b) | | • went early<br>• couldn't find classroom<br>• late for the first lesson/by 15 minutes<br><br>**Any 2 from 3** | **2** | |
| | (c) | | • students have (more) **freedom** at universities<br>• students can choose more/many **subjects** at universities<br><br>**Any 1 from 2** | **1** | |
| | (d) | | • learnt independence<br>• did things on his own<br>• learnt cooking skills<br>• learnt room-cleaning skills<br><br>**Any 3 from 4** | **3** | |
| | (e) | | • his teachers **are like** friends<br>• some teachers have a sense of humour/like to tell jokes<br>• he is happy **in class**<br><br>**Any 2 from 3** | **2** | |
| | (f) | | • tuition **fees** are expensive<br>• gain work experience **before graduation** | **2** | |

**[END OF MARKING INSTRUCTION]**



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